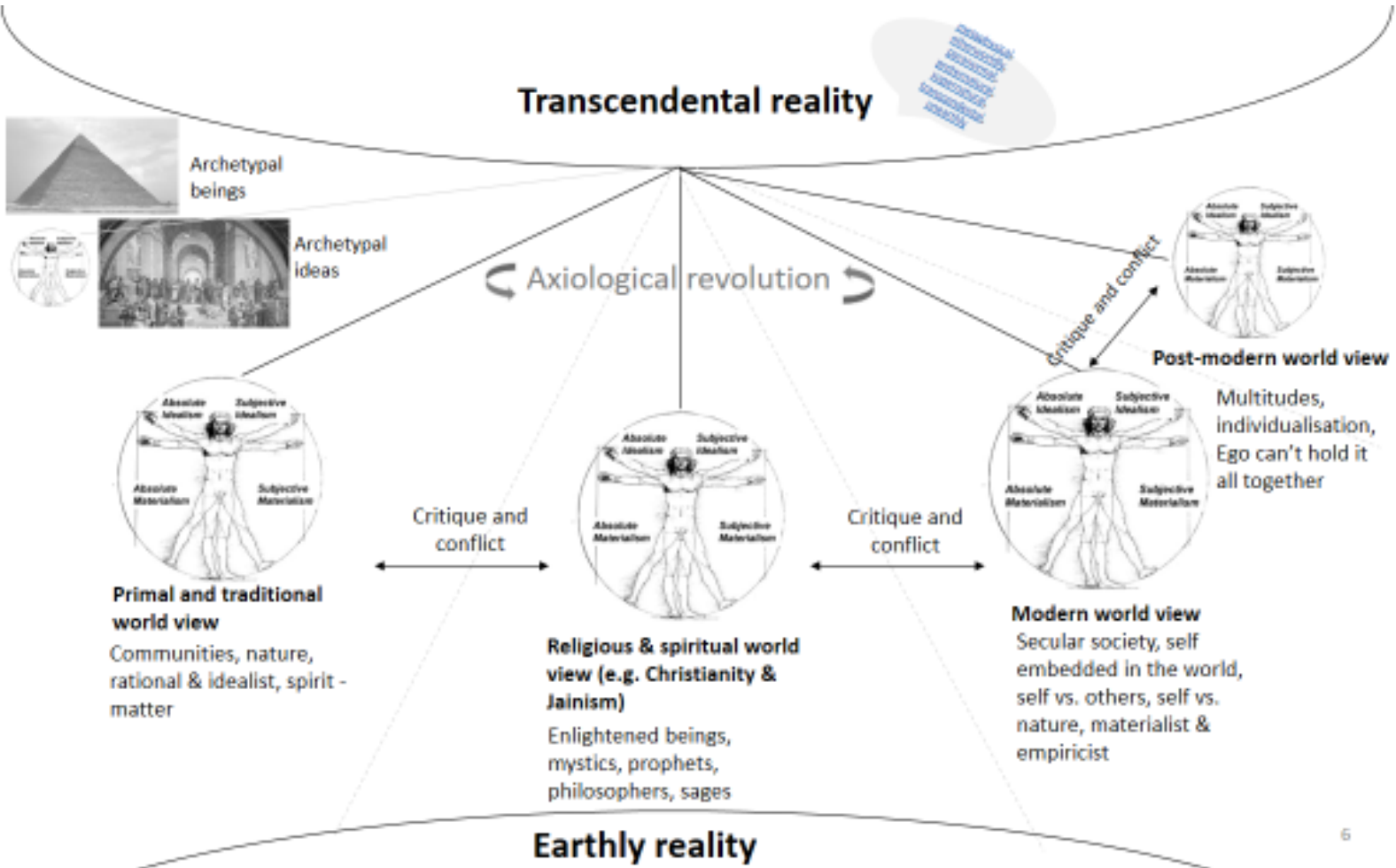


1. The bigger picture:



## 2. An absolutised idea

Remember, an ideology is a type of paradigm. When a group of people (society) established a norm or a specific philosophy/ a way of life/ a religion/ they tend to idealise this by formulating an idea on which the paradigm is based. This is called an absolutised idea.

According to Heyns (2008:32), an ideology consists of an absolutised idea that motivates an oppressive social system. More comprehensively, ideology can be defined as a totalitarianistic, theoretical and practically institutionalised system that presupposes / causes distorted / oppressive social norms, means and relations in order to realise an absolutised idea regarding the way in which the social world clicks into place.

When the followers of an ideology seeks to establish the idea, or protect it, then its followers can idolise the idea.

### 2.1 Examples of ideologies

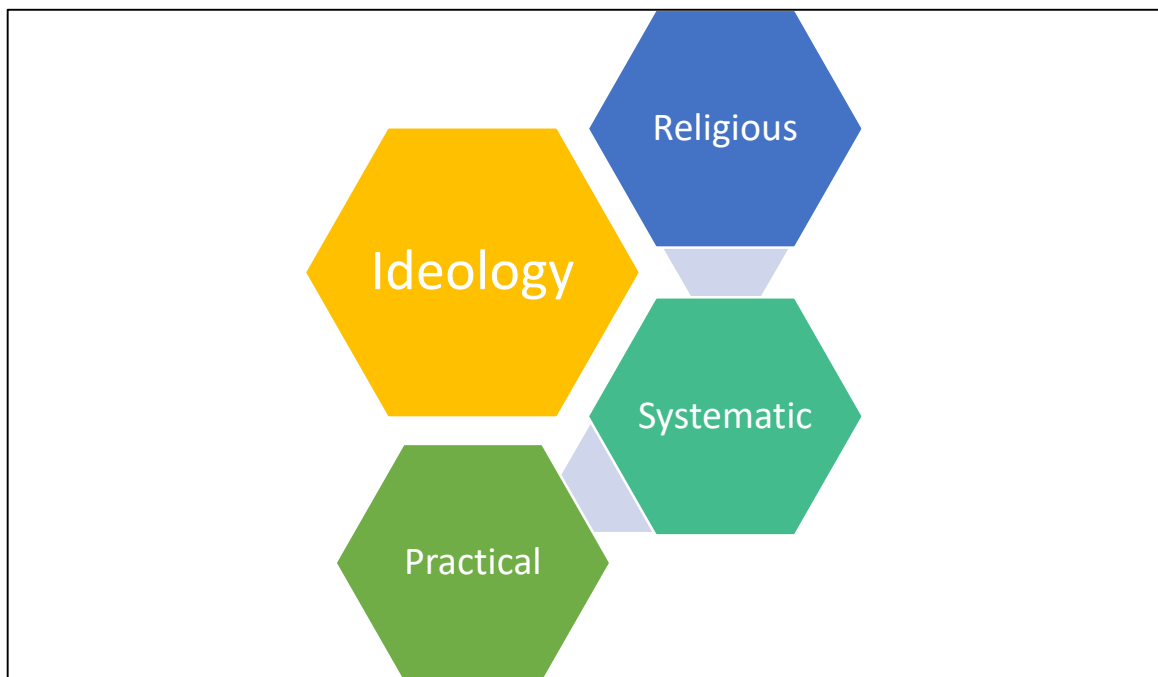
\* **Communism:** a theory or system of social organization in which all property is owned by the community and each person contributes and receives according to their ability and needs.

\* **Capitalism:** Capitalism is an economic system characterized by private ownership of the means of production, especially in the industrial sector.

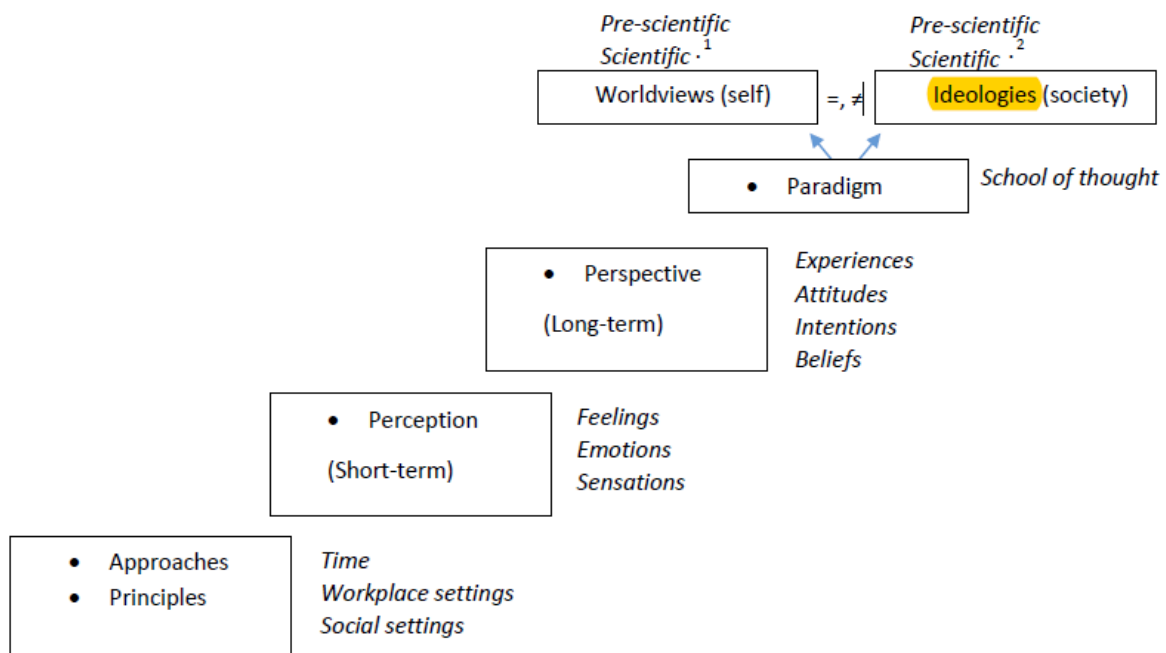
\* **Liberalism:** Liberalism, political doctrine that takes protecting and enhancing the freedom of the individual to be the central problem of politics. Liberals typically believe that government is necessary to protect individuals from being harmed by others, but they also recognize that government itself can pose a threat to liberty.

\* **Apartheid:** Apartheid made laws forced the different racial groups to live separately and develop separately

## 2.2 Dimensions of an ideology



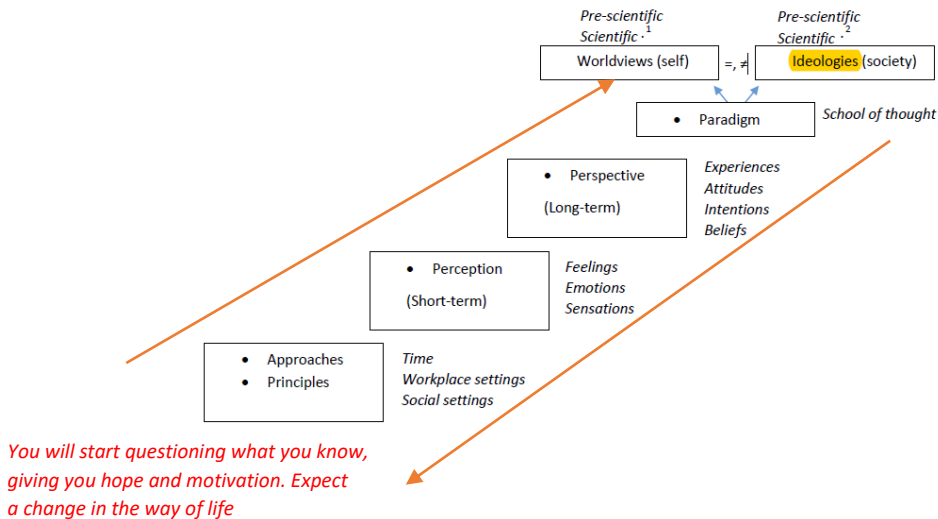
An ideology can begin with any dimension. An ideology can grab hold of, and grow within, a society finding inroads via any one of the three dimensions, and from there it can call forth or set into motion the other three dimensions as these dimensions support each other.



Each dimension has a unique set of strategies that aim to establish the ideology.

### 2.2.1 Religious dimension

When the ideology infiltrates the principles and approaches, it steadily changes the perception and perspective, ultimately leading to a change in the worldview. It does so **by promising a new or better life**. However, in this process it is possible that there arise some tensions between the worldview and the ideology.

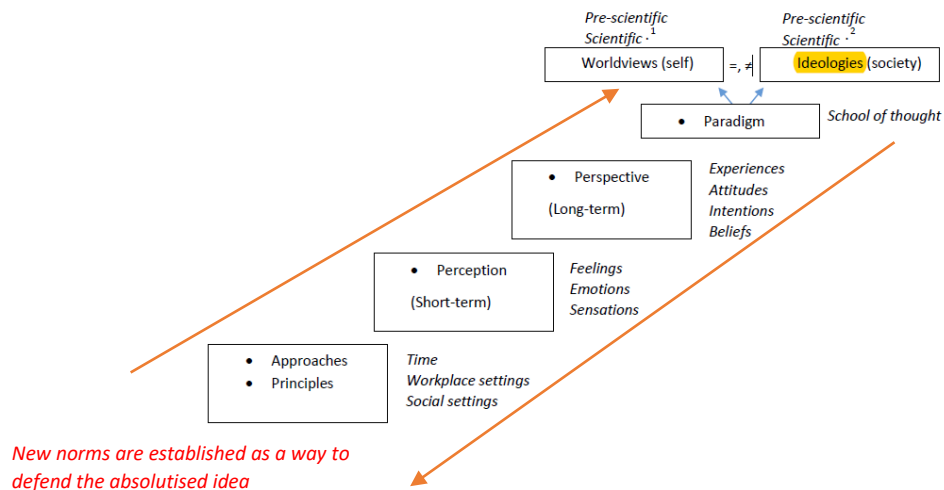


#### 2.2.1.1 Strategies

The ideology is **communicated as a perfect solution** for something that is missing from society (e.g. lack of economic stability). It therefore depends upon a situation of lack or oppression. In order to overcome this lack or oppression, the ideology promises a goal (seen as the absolutised idea) of restructuring and re-establishing society for the purpose of self-preservation. It exploits suffering and promises transformation but in doing so distorts the norms (that is: it provides principles that you are not comfortable).

### 2.2.2 Systematic dimension

The new or better life is explained and demonstrated in order to provide an understanding of this absolutised idea. **New rules or norms or communicated** such that ethical norms become distorted. These change in laws, norms and rules are defended by explaining that they are necessary to support the greater (absolutised) idea – so they are masked as a means for a greater purpose.

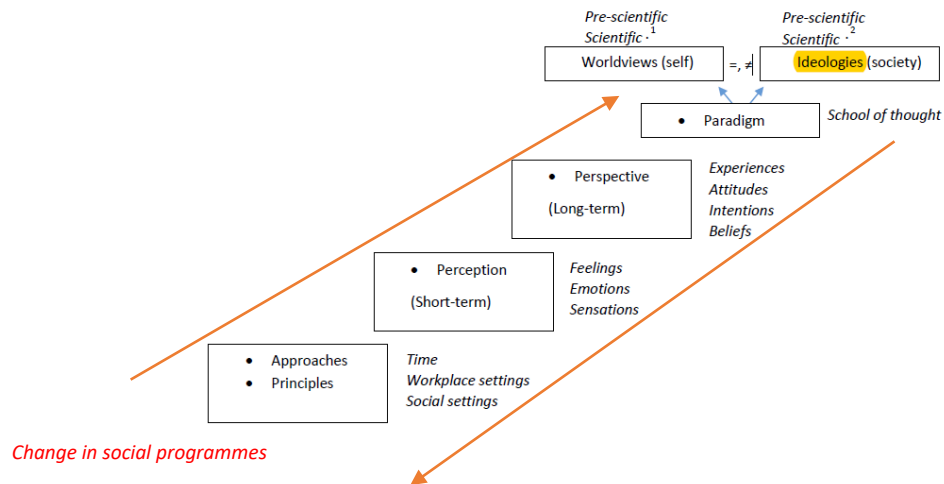


#### 2.2.2.1 Strategies

It promises a working system that serves justice but reinterprets what justice means. Language is often misused to cover up, deny or diffuse issues. The approach to implement the absolutised idea it promised as a temporary solution, but exceeds its time and takes on a permanent form.

### 2.2.3 Practical dimension

The new ethics provides the establishment of **new laws and social programmes** in order to realise the absolutised idea. The ideology emerges then in two stages: (i) first those who hear it make meaning and sense from it as they become motivated and then (ii) act upon the message of the absolutised idea by transforming the principles of the ideology into their own lives.



### 2.2.3.1 Strategies

Imposing the absolutised idea by using force. Ideas are often rephrased and formed into laws. It promises a united identity, but fragments any opposing party.

